Multiple Match Player Report Individual Performance Analysis

Scout: Cal Botterill

Club: RC Strasbourg

Competition: Ligue 1

Player: Valentin Barco

Report Type: 3-Match Scouting Report

Venues: Stade de la Meinau, Parc des Princes

Matches and Dates:

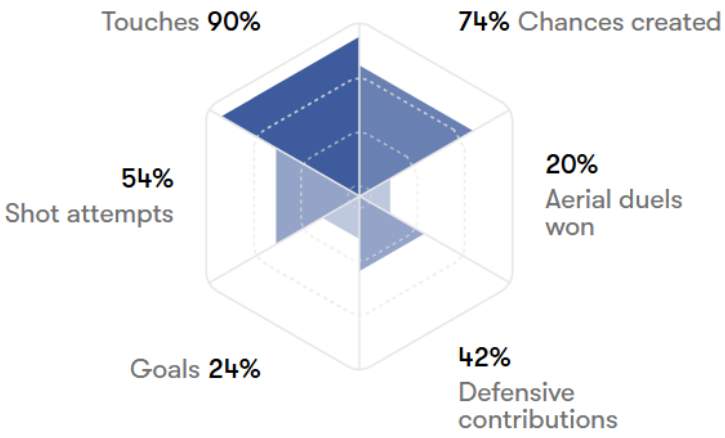
RC Strasbourg vs Olympique de Marseille 26th September 2025

RC Strasbourg vs Angers SCO 05th October 2025

Paris Saint Germain vs RC Strasbourg 17th October 2025

Tournament	Apps	Mins	Goals	Assists	Yel	Red	SpG	PS%	AerialsWon	MotM	Rating
Ligue 1	13(1)	1155	1	4	2	1	1.1	85.4	0.4	1	7.23
Conference League	1(3)	N/A	-	N/A	2	-	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	-
Conference League Qualification	2	N/A	-	N/A	-	-	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	-
Total / Average	20	1155	1	4	4	1	1.1	85.4	0.4	1	7.23

Final Score 1-2



1	Mason Greenwood, Forward	7.65	1	Valentín Barco, Midfielder	7.24
2	Gerónimo Rulli, Goalkeeper	7.42	2	Diego Moreira, Forward	7.01
3	Nayef Aguerd, Defender	7.35	3	Joaquin Panichelli, Forward	6.97
4	Pierre-Emile Højbjerg, Midfielder	7.28	4	Mike Penders, Goalkeeper	6.94
5	Pierre-Emerick Aubameyang, Forward	7.06	5	Samuel Amo-Ameyaw, Midfielder	6.87

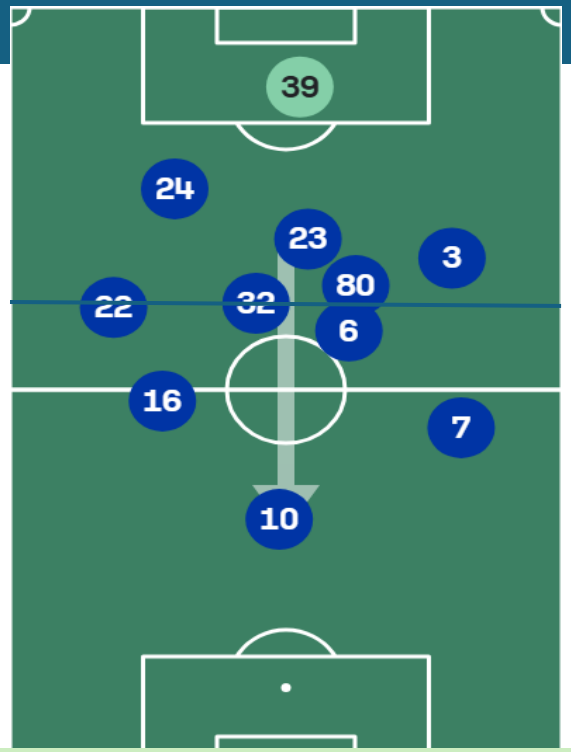
Match 1 Overview

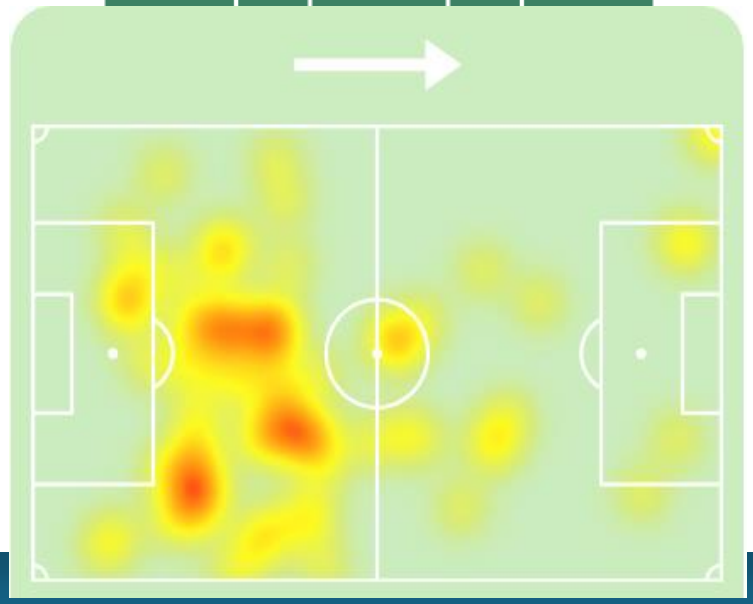
RC Strasbourg vs Olympique de Marseille 26th September 2025

Pre-Observation Profile (Valentín Barco CM/CDM)

- High-touch central midfielder; likely to dictate tempo and link phases rather than provide direct goal threat.
- Chance-creation profile suggests creative influence from deeper zones, likely via progressive passes and carries.
- Defensive output projects as positional and anticipatory, not duel- or aerial-dominant.
- Physical profile may be exposed in transition-heavy or direct match-ups, particularly on second balls.

Heatmap and Average Positioning





Player Performance Breakdown

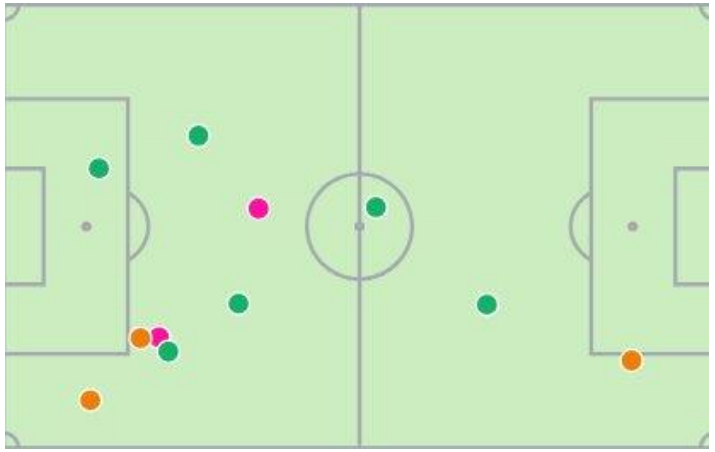
Match Statistic Analysis

Movement & Positioning

- Right-sided CM; consistent occupation of right half-space in possession.
- Support-first movement profile; regularly drops towards ball to offer angles.
- Holds central structure; limited vertical runs beyond midfield line.
- OOP positioning focused on lane-screening rather than stepping out.
- Role profile aligns with support 8 / pivot-adjacent midfielder.

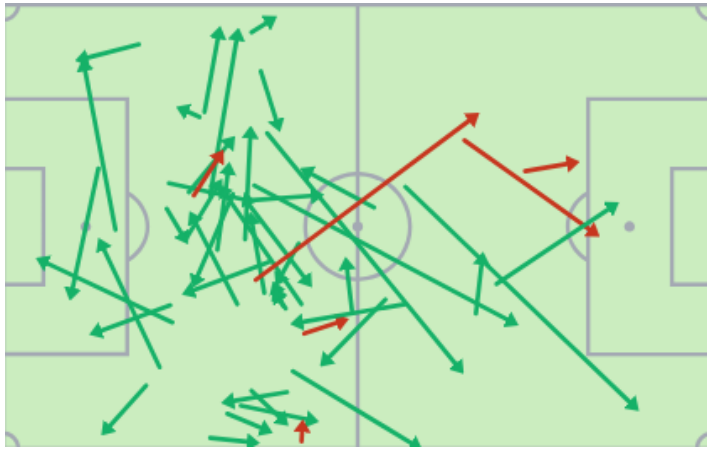
Player Performance Breakdown

Match Statistic Analysis



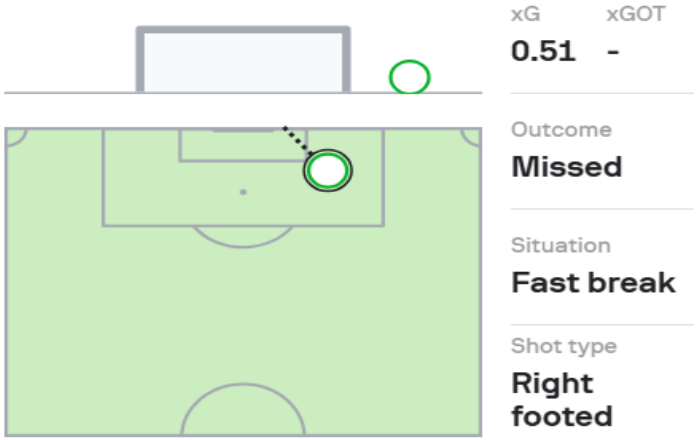
Tackles 3 (2)
Interceptions 2
Clearances 0
Blocked shots 0
Recoveries 6
Ground duels (won)10 (8)
Aerial duels (won)1 (0)

- Defensive actions concentrated in right-central zones, reflecting positional discipline rather than wide coverage.
- Tackles and interceptions mainly executed ahead of the back line, showing proactive engagement in midfield spaces.
- Recovery volume indicates good anticipation and second-ball awareness.
- Limited aerial involvement; defensive impact ground-based and positional.



Assists 0
Expected assists (xA) 0.24
Key passes 0
Accurate passes 44/50 (88%)
Passes in opposition half (6/11 (55%)
Passes in own half (38/41 (93%)
Long balls Accuracy (3/4 (75%)

- High pass volume and accuracy, strong in possession
- Majority of passes in own half, reinforcing function as a deep lying playmaker role.
- Selective forward and diagonal passes show progressive intent.
- Limited final-third output; influence came through recycling of possession and pre-assist distribution..



Goals 0
Expected Goals (xG) 0.51
Total shots 1
Shots on target 0
Shots blocked 0
Big chances missed 1

- Single shot taken from a high-value central area during a fast-break situation.
- Chance quality was high; execution lacking.
- Shooting involvement appears opportunistic rather than role-driven.

Positional Adaptability

Valentín Barco shows strong adaptability across roles, having previously operated as a left-back / wing-back before transitioning into central midfield. His technical security, press resistance, and passing range allow him to function effectively as a central or deep-lying midfielder, while his energy and anticipation suit high-pressing and transitional demands. This background supports his ability to adjust between positions without loss of tactical effectiveness.

Players Technical and Tactical Strengths and Areas to Improve

Technical Strengths

- Clean first touch under pressure; consistently escapes high presses and initiates progression (06:06, 10:36, 15:19).
- Strong passing range as a recycling playmaker in possession, dictating tempo through short circulation and longer distribution including clipped balls in behind opposition defense (15:29, 31:33, 71:52).
- Secure ball protection in tight central areas; regularly draws fouls to relieve pressure and reset structure (23:34, 67:50, 79:19).
- Set-piece delivery from corners and free kicks shows good technical consistency and variation (31:33, 61:41).

Technical Weaknesses

- Final-third execution inconsistent; inventive attempts do not always come off despite good intent (55:25).
- Limited goal threat from open play; shooting involvement appears opportunistic rather than role-driven (19:54).

Tactical Strengths

- In possession: operates as a recycling deep-lying playmaker, frequently dropping alongside Centre-Backs to receive and initiate build-up (general observation; consistently evident throughout first and second half).
- Out of possession: functions as a high-energy pressing midfielder, stepping forward to engage and disrupt opposition build-up with well understood pressing cues and strong anticipation (01:34, 14:45, 19:54).
- Strong transitional contribution, tracking back aggressively to halt counter-attacks and regain control (67:50).
- Intelligent game management through quick free kicks and tempo control when under pressure (23:34, 79:19).

Tactical Weaknesses

- Pressing intensity can lead to occasional over-commitment, allowing opponents to bypass him (54:11).
- Risk management: attempted quick restart in a dangerous area nearly resulted in a concession (79:21).

Observed Physical and Mental Attributes Strengths and Areas of Improvement

Physical Attributes

Strengths

Barco shows a strong physical engine, maintaining high activity levels throughout the match. He repeatedly covers ground to support pressing, recovery runs, and defensive actions from central areas, including effective tracking back during opposition transitions (67:50). His ability to sustain intensity late into the game suggests good stamina and repeat-effort capacity.

Areas for Improvement

His physical profile can be tested against more direct or physically dominant midfielders. He offers limited aerial presence and is less effective in physical duels that rely on strength rather than positioning or anticipation.

Mental Attributes

Strengths

Barco demonstrates good composure and confidence, remaining calm when operating under pressure in deep or dangerous areas (10:36). He shows strong anticipation and concentration, evidenced by early interceptions and proactive defensive actions (01:34). His willingness to stay involved and take responsibility reflects a positive competitive mindset.

Areas for Improvement

His desire to play with tempo and initiative can occasionally lead to over-risking situations, such as attempting quick restarts in high-risk areas (79:21). This suggests scope to refine decision-making and game management at higher levels.

Match 1 Initial Indicators

Valentín Barco delivered a standout performance in central midfield and was RC Strasbourg's best player in a strong test against Olympique de Marseille. Operating as the primary deep-lying organiser, he performed effectively despite Marseille's aggressive pressing and direct midfield play, with much of his contest coming against Pierre-Emile Højbjerg, providing a high-level benchmark.

Barco combined high involvement with efficiency on the ball, recording 88% pass accuracy (44/50), 75% long-ball accuracy (3/4) and 0.24 xA, reflecting his influence in progression and chance creation from deeper zones. Defensively, he contributed 3 tackles, 2 interceptions and 6 recoveries, pressing proactively and recovering well in transition. Overall, he showed composure, intensity, and tactical discipline in a demanding midfield duel against elite opposition.

Initial Overall Strengths

- High-volume, secure passer who dictates tempo from deep midfield zones.
- Comfortable receiving under pressure and progressing play against a high press.
- Strong anticipation and work rate; effective in pressing and recovery actions.
- Good long-range distribution and set-piece delivery.
- Competitive and proactive, consistently involved in both phases.

Initial Overall Weaknesses

- Limited aerial impact; defensive effectiveness relies on positioning rather than physical dominance.
- Final-third output more creative than decisive; goal threat remains secondary.
- Occasionally over-ambitious with tempo management in high-risk areas.

Type of Player

Deep-Lying Playmaker / Pressing Hybrid CM

A high-touch, tempo-setting central midfielder who recycles possession in build-up and presses aggressively out of possession.

SCOUTIQ

Match 2 Overview

RC Strasbourg vs Angers SCO 05th October 2025

Match 2 – Observation Focus

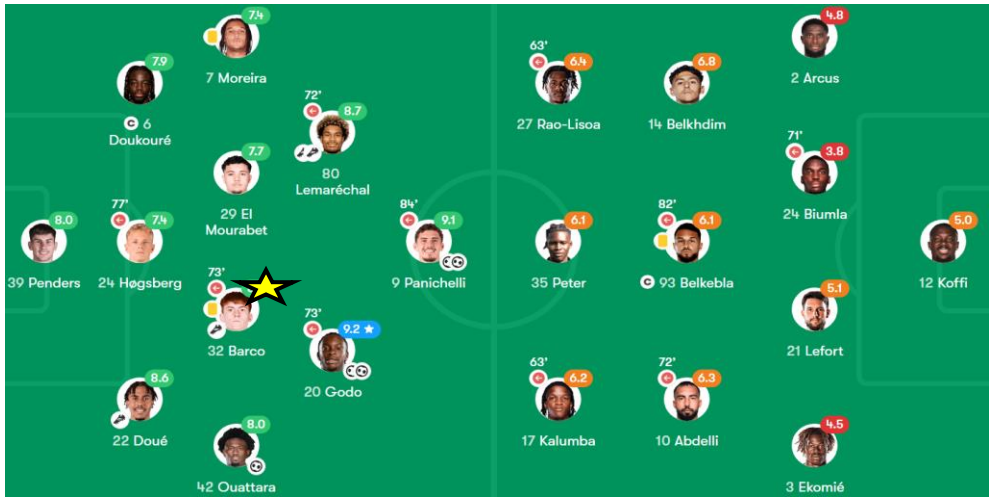
This match was used to assess Barco's ability to maintain influence and discipline against weaker opposition, with focus on how he controls the match, positioning in possession, and decision-making with increased time and space, following his strong performance in Match 1.

Sun, October 5, 4:15 PM | Stade de la Meinau | Guillaume Paradis

Strasbourg **5 - 0** Angers

Full time

Panichelli 36', 51'
Ouattara 61'
Godo 66', 70'



Ball possession

66%		34%
4.73	Expected goals (xG)	0.32
18	Total shots	5
8	Big chances	0

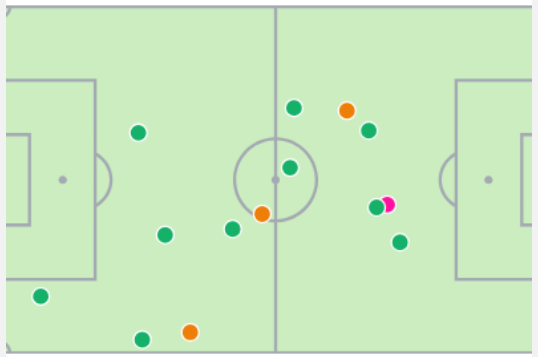
Player Performance Breakdown
Match Statistic Analysis

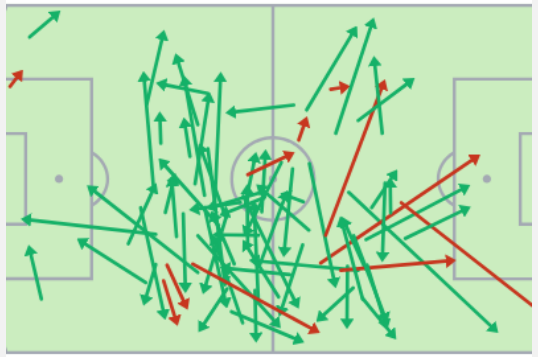
Valentín Barco operated as a high-involvement central midfielder, recording **95 touches** and **86% pass accuracy**, with consistent occupation of central. He controlled circulation effectively (**93% own half, 76% opposition half**) while providing clear creative output (**5 key passes, 2 big chances created, 1 assist, 0.8 xA**).
Defensively, he remained engaged despite Strasbourg's dominance, registering **10 recoveries**, **3 tackles (2 won)** and **6/9 ground duels won**, with actions concentrated centrally, reflecting positional discipline.
Limitations were evident in reduced long-range distribution (**1/5 long balls**), minimal ball-carrying impact (**0/1 dribbles completed**), some ball losses in congested central areas (**13 possession losses**), and limited aerial influence (**0/1 aerial duels won**).

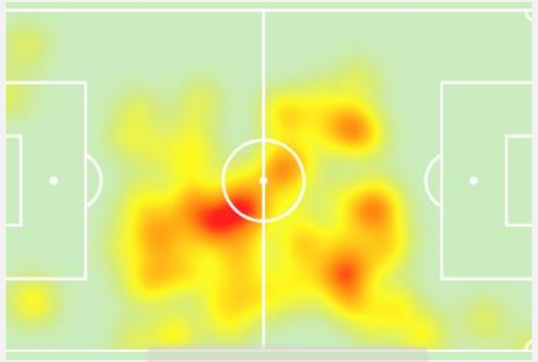
Overall
Touches: **95**
Possession lost: **13**
Fouled: **3**
Fouls committed: **1**
Dribbles: **1**

Passing & Creation
Accurate passes: **68 / 79 (86%)**
Passes in own half (accurate): **43 / 46 (93%)**
Passes in opposition half (accurate): **25 / 33 (76%)**
Key passes: **5**
Assists: **1**
Expected assists (xA): **0.8**
Big chances created: **2**
Crosses (accurate): **3 (3)**
Long balls (accurate): **1 / 5 (20%)**

Defensive Actions
Defensive contributions: **4**
Tackles (won): **3 (2)**
Interceptions: **1**
Recoveries: **10**
Ground duels (won): **9 (6)**
Aerial duels (won): **1 (0)**
Clearances: **0**
Blocked shots: **0**







Players Technical and Tactical Strengths and Areas to Improve

Technical Strengths

- Confident and secure in possession; comfortable receiving under pressure and playing first-time combinations (08:13, 32:06).
- Strong creative passing between lines and in behind the defence, producing high-quality chances for teammates (01:45, 25:01, 34:53).
- Good vision and execution on clipped passes and crosses, particularly in attacking phases and set plays (42:30, 60:06).
- Composed when capitalising on opposition errors, maintaining balance and quality in decisive moments (34:53).

Technical Areas to Improve

- Ball security inconsistent in deeper areas, with possession lost under limited pressure (09:40, 35:21, 38:04, 64:00).
- Over-reliance on first-time bounce passes limits ability to turn and drive attacks when space is available (02:00, 03:23).
- Long-range passing execution inconsistent despite positive intent (06:35, 16:04).
- Set-piece delivery quality variable (32:56).

Tactical Strengths

- Key figure in initiating and sustaining attacks, regularly involved in build-up and final-third creation (01:45, 25:01, 65:29).
- Intelligent anticipation to intercept or steal possession and immediately transition into attack (34:53, 39:54).
- Demonstrates good positional awareness and tactical responsibility, including covering at left-back when required (56:06).

Tactical Areas to Improve

- Defensive impact slower to establish in early phases, with limited tackles or interceptions initially (early first half).
- Can be bypassed by quick circulation rather than direct duels, reducing defensive influence in lower-intensity matches.
- Occasional unnecessary defensive risk, shown by a needless yellow card from an over-ambitious challenge (25:20).

Observed Physical and Mental Attributes Strengths and Areas of Improvement

Physical Strengths

- Shows good balance and coordination under pressure, able to ride challenges and maintain control in tight areas (32:06, 34:53).
- Covers ground well in midfield and demonstrates recovery capacity, including tracking back and recovery tackles (45:49).
- Physically capable of adapting to defensive responsibilities, including covering at left-back when required (56:06).

Physical Areas to Improve

- Physical duels can be inconsistent; occasionally loses out when isolated or caught in possession (09:40).
- Aerial presence remains limited, offering little impact in aerial contests.

Mental Strengths

- Confident and composed in possession; regularly checks shoulder before receiving and looks to play quickly to maintain tempo (08:13).
- Strong anticipation and alertness, capitalising on opposition mistakes and reacting quickly to loose balls (34:53, 39:54).
- Positive attacking mindset; consistently looks to create chances and take responsibility in the final third (01:45, 25:01).

Mental Areas to Improve

- Decision-making under lower pressure can fluctuate, leading to unnecessary turnovers in central areas (35:21, 38:04, 64:00).
- Can show over-eagerness in defensive actions, resulting in avoidable fouls or bookings (25:20).
- At times defaults to the safe first-time option rather than assessing opportunities to turn and progress play more directly (02:00, 03:23).

Overall Trends after 2 Games

- Valentín Barco is emerging as a control- and creation-focused central midfielder, with his contribution best measured through influence, progression, and chance creation rather than goal output. This aligns with his low xG profile (~0.1 xG/90), reinforcing that scoring is not a primary function of his role.

- Defensively, a clear trend is his anticipatory rather than physical defending. Across both matches, his impact has come through recoveries, interceptions, pressing triggers, and positioning, rather than aerial dominance or high-volume tackling. He consistently reads passing lanes, steps in to regain possession, and supports counter-pressing phases, particularly when the opposition attempts to play out.

- There is also a game-state dependency. Against stronger opposition, his defensive discipline and positional control were more pronounced, contributing to midfield stability. Against weaker opposition, his defensive involvement dropped slightly, with greater emphasis placed on creative responsibility, leading to occasional bypassing through passing rather than duels.

- Overall, two matches suggest a midfielder whose defensive value lies in intelligence, work rate, and anticipation, complementing his on-ball influence. This supports his profile as a deep-lying / support playmaker who contributes defensively through structure and reading of the game, not physical dominance.

Tournament	Apps	Mins	xG	Goals	xGDiff	xG/90	Shots	xG/Shots	Rating
Ligue 1	13(1)	1155	1.04	1	-0.04	0.08	16	0.07	7.23
Total / Average	14	1155	1	1	0	0.1	16	0.1	7.23

Match 3 Overview

Paris Saint Germain vs RC Strasbourg
17th October 2025

Final Score 3-3

Opposition Context

Paris Saint-Germain provide a step up in intensity and quality, offering a clear opportunity to test whether trends observed in the first two matches **hold under elite pressure**, particularly in central midfield areas.

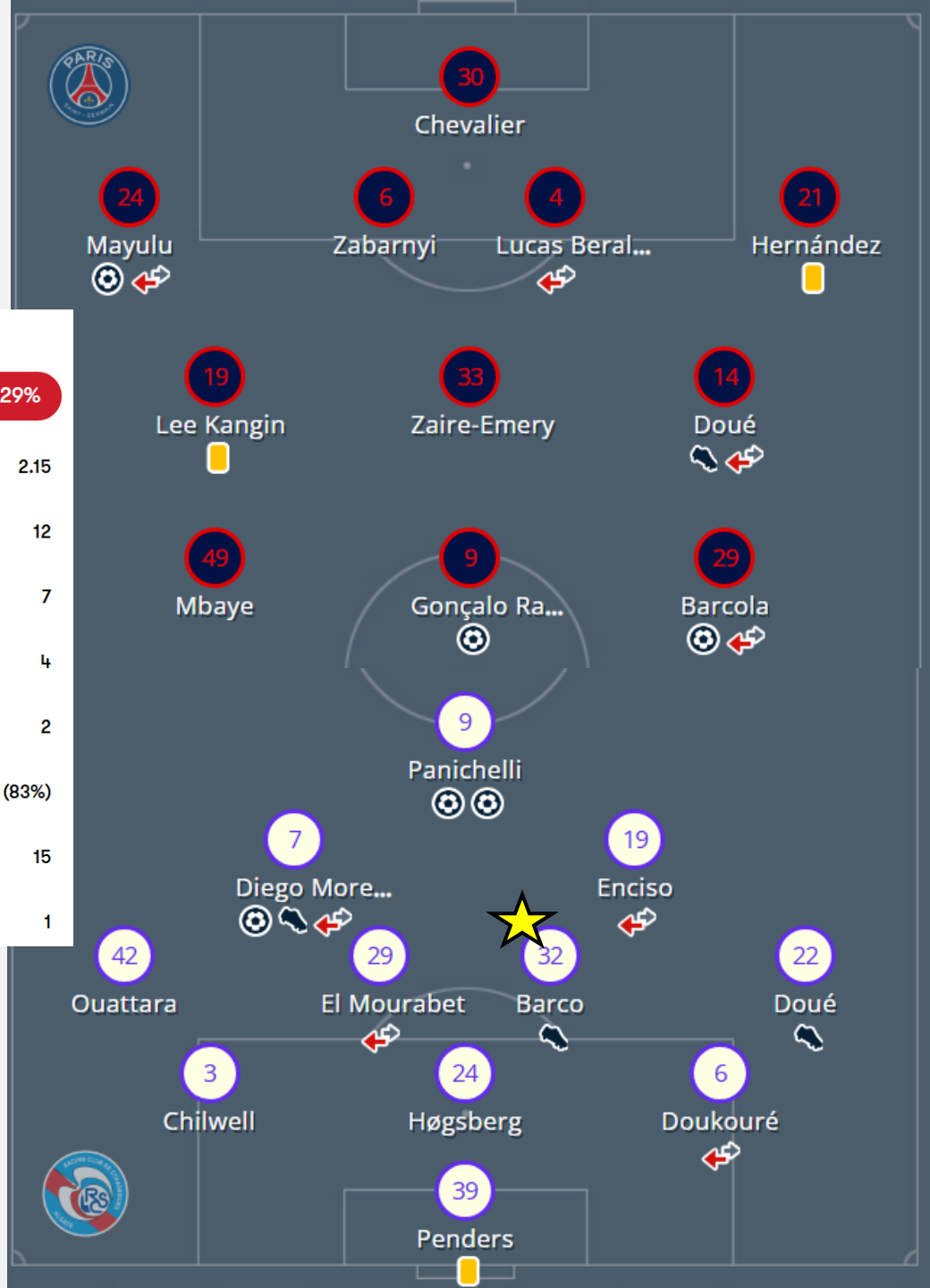
Observation Focus

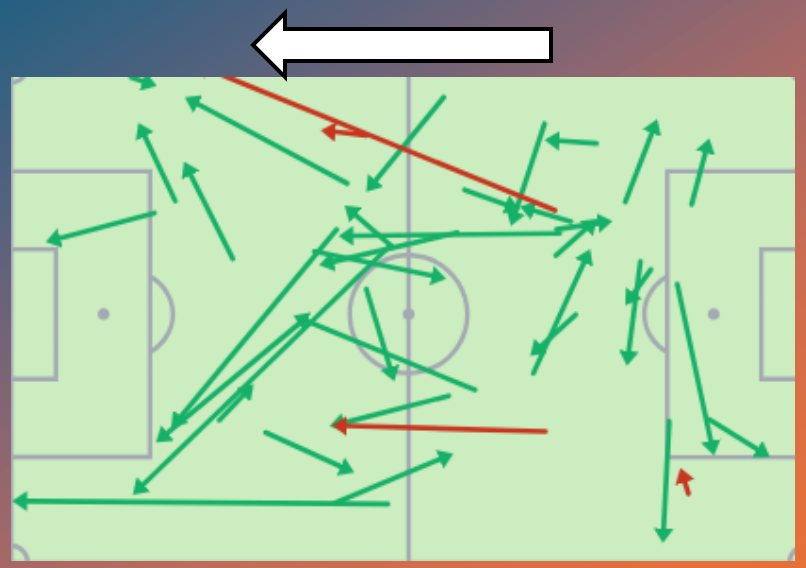
- **Defensive protection:** how effectively he screens the back line and supports defensive structure against higher-quality attackers.
- **Ball security:** whether he can maintain control and composure in possession under sustained high pressure, compared to Match 1 and 2.
- **Attacking influence:** ability to impact the game creatively through chance creation and progression when time and space are limited.
- **Role adaptation:** whether his positioning and responsibilities change due to tactical demands, and how well he executes within that role.

Ball possession

71% | 29%

2.67	Expected goals (xG)	2.15
21	Total shots	12
9	Shots on target	7
5	Big chances	4
2	Big chances missed	2
717 (92%)	Accurate passes	257 (83%)
12	Fouls committed	15
4	Corners	1





Match stats in comparison to match 2

- **Volume & shape:** Fewer total passes (54 touches) and a more compact passing map.
- **Decision-making:** Shorter, safer connections with selective forward passes.
- **Efficiency:** Very high accuracy (90% overall; 86% in opposition half).
- **Adaptation:** Still able to create (1 assist, 1 big chance) despite reduced involvement.

Stat link:

- 35/39 passes (90%)
- 3/4 accurate long balls (75%)
- 1 assist, 0.15 xA
- Lower possession loss (9)

Against elite pressure, Barco sacrificed volume for efficiency, adapting his game to retain structure and still influence key moments.

Overall Trend

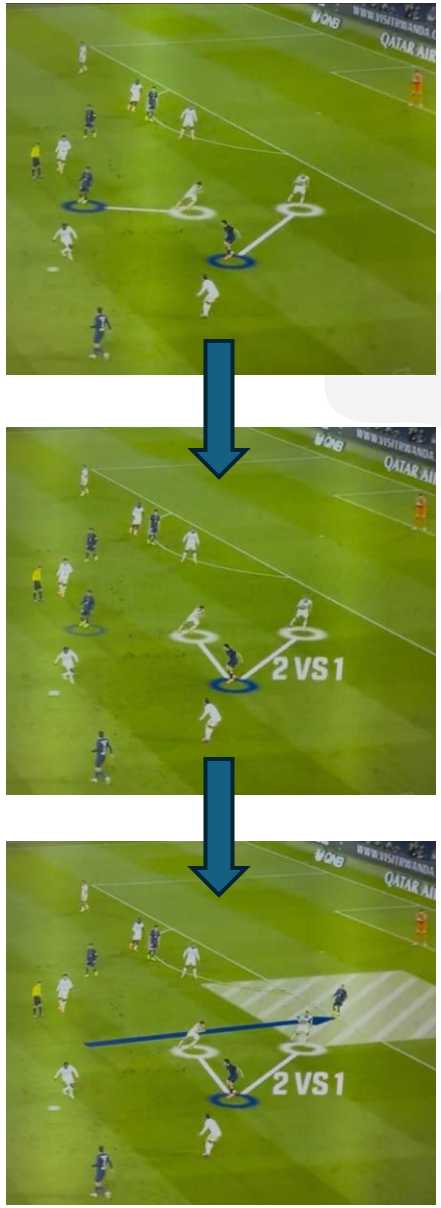
- When given control, Barco dictates tempo and progression.
- When control is limited, he simplifies, protects possession, and chooses moments.
- Passing maps and stats together show tactical intelligence and adaptability, not a drop in confidence.

Barco demonstrates the ability to scale his passing game to opposition level — operating as a high-volume controller against weaker sides and an efficient, selective distributor against elite pressure.

Player Performance Breakdown
Match Statistic Analysis

The rating breakdown showcased Barco's attributes in possession control and intelligent distribution, with enough defensive competitiveness to survive elite pressure, but limited goal threat or ball-carrying influence in this match.

Players Technical and Tactical Strengths and Areas to Improve



Defensive lapse from Barco leading to PSG eqauliser

Technical & Tactical Strengths

- **Composure under pressure:** Remained calm receiving under pressure, using close control and body positioning to retain possession and win fouls (17:06, 47:22, 50:54).
- **Creative execution in decisive moments:** Delivered an excellent assist with disguise and weight of pass, creating a clear scoring opportunity (40:42). Continued to show creativity late with through balls and ball carries (84:42, 91:28).
- **Passing variety:** Demonstrated ability to switch play and break lines with longer distribution when space allowed (17:06, 53:29).
- **Tactical discipline in structure:** Showed good understanding of team shape by dropping into the back line when Centre-backs stepped out, maintaining defensive balance (12:10).
- **Positional intelligence in wide coverage:** Effectively covered as a left wing-back in a back five, reading play well to intercept and regain possession (68:40).
- **Tempo control in spells:** Had short periods where he successfully dictated tempo and recycled possession under pressure (18:39).

Technical & Tactical Areas to Improve

- **Defensive awareness off the ball:** Lost track of runners on multiple occasions, contributing to dangerous situations and goals conceded (05:14, 32:42, 78:50).
- **1v1 defending:** Pressed aggressively but was beaten too easily in isolated duels, particularly when stepping out of position (08:42, 60:51).
- **Risk management in possession:** Over-reliance on first-time bounce passes without scanning led to turnovers in central areas (31:23).
- **Decision-making when anticipating:** At times attempted to read play too early rather than holding shape, allowing opponents to exploit space behind him (19:56, 60:51).

Observed Physical and Mental Attributes Strengths and Areas of Improvement

Strengths

- **Work rate & mobility:** Covered significant ground across central and wide areas, supporting defensive structure and showing willingness to recover into deeper positions when required (04:13, 12:10, 68:40).
- **Balance under pressure:** Maintained control when challenged, using body positioning to stay upright and win fouls in tight areas (47:22, 50:54).
- **Competitive mentality:** Showed fight in duels and contested moments, repeatedly engaging physically and mentally despite sustained PSG pressure (73:23).
- **Confidence in adversity:** Continued to demand the ball and attempt positive actions even after mistakes or defensive setbacks (18:39, 40:42, 91:28).

Areas to Improve

- **1v1 defensive physicality:** Struggled to contain opponents in isolated duels, particularly when stepping out aggressively rather than delaying (08:42, 60:51).
- **Concentration off the ball:** Lost awareness of runners on several occasions, leading to dangerous situations and goals conceded (05:14, 32:42, 78:50).
- **Mental reset after transitions:** Occasional lapses immediately following turnovers or set-piece situations (03:06).

Performance Trends & Role Identification

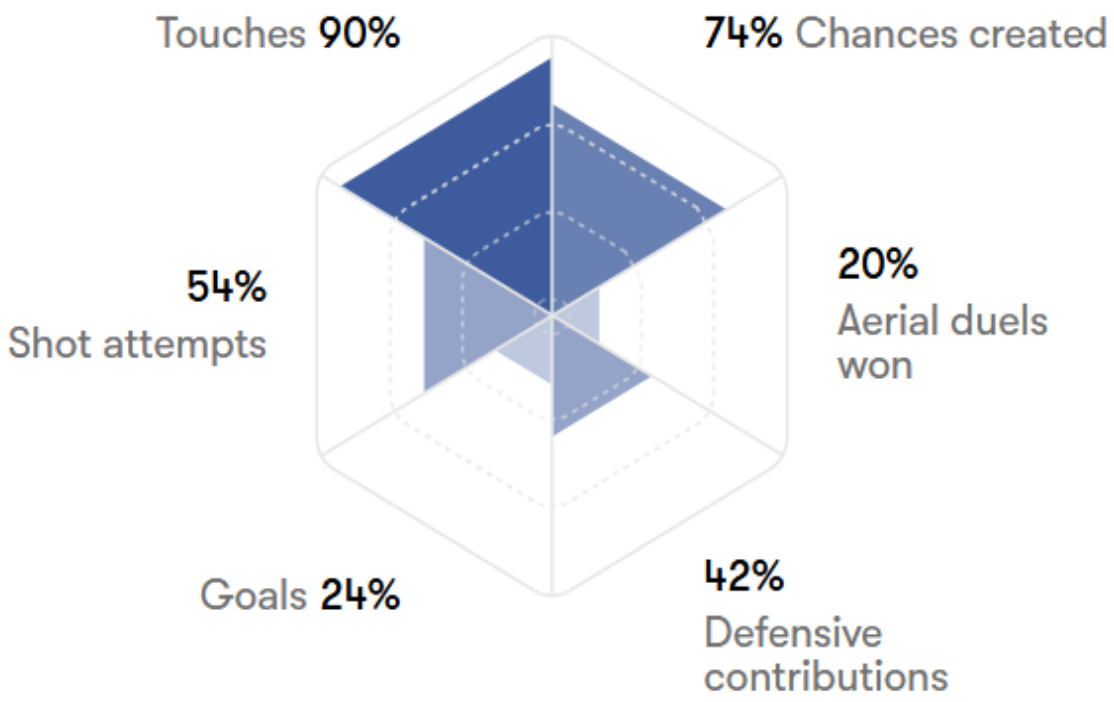
Across three matches, Valentín Barco has consistently operated as a box-to-box central midfielder, with his influence shaped by game state and opposition level. His role combines supporting build-up, controlling tempo, and contributing to chance creation, while also covering ground defensively rather than operating as a fixed deep pivot.

A clear trend is evident in how his box-to-box function adapts to opposition quality. Against weaker teams, Barco assumes greater on-ball responsibility, increasing his passing volume, dictating tempo, and driving attacking phases from midfield. Against stronger and elite opposition, his role becomes more selective and disciplined, with emphasis on ball security, positional responsibility, and supporting defensive structure rather than sustained control.

In terms of game influence, Barco impacts matches through movement, link play, and transitional involvement rather than goal output. His low xG profile across the matches reflects a midfielder whose value lies assists, and pre-assist actions, while defensively contributing through recoveries, pressing actions, and positional coverage across multiple zones.

Tactically, his role fluctuates between a high-involvement box-to-box presence in dominant game states and a support-oriented midfielder in high-intensity fixtures, where defensive concentration and efficient ball use become priorities. This ability to scale responsibility across matches is a defining trend from the three-game sample.

Key Strengths & Development Priorities



Barco Strengths	Areas to Develop
• **Box-to-Box Influence & Work Rate** Across the three-match sample, Barco consistently demonstrated the profile of a high-energy box-to-box midfielder, influencing games in multiple phases. He contributes both in build-up and defensive transitions, adapting his involvement based on game state and opposition level. • **Composure & Ball Security Under Pressure** Barco showed consistent calmness when receiving in tight central areas, particularly against stronger opposition. He adapts well under pressure, prioritising efficient decision-making and ball retention when time and space are limited. • **Creative Output from Deeper Zones** His attacking contribution is driven by progression and chance creation rather than goal threat. Across the matches, he consistently contributed assists, key passes, and pre-assist actions, remaining influential even when operating deeper. • **Tactical Intelligence & Role Adaptability** Barco demonstrated strong understanding of team structure, adjusting his positioning to support the back line, cover wide areas, and alter responsibility based on tactical demands. His ability to scale his role across matches is a clear strength. • **Competitive Mentality & Resilience** He remained confident and willing to take responsibility even after mistakes or under sustained pressure. His work rate, engagement in duels, and willingness to remain involved reflect a strong competitive mindset.	Defensively, greater awareness of off-ball runners is required, particularly against elite opposition, where lapses are punished quickly. In 1v1 situations, he can step out too aggressively, reducing his ability to delay play and protect central spaces. Improvements in defensive patience and positioning would enhance his reliability. In possession, there is scope to improve **spatial awareness before receiving**, particularly when opting for first-time bounce passes. While this option provides early security and tempo control, it can become **predictable as matches progress**, allowing opponents to anticipate and step in to intercept. Barco already demonstrates the **technical ability to carry the ball effectively**, but does not utilise it often enough. Increasing his willingness to turn, carry, and vary his progression would reduce predictability, improve game control over time, and **increase his attacking threat** by accessing advanced areas more directly.

Projection, Role Fit & Readiness

At 21 years old, in his first season at a new club, Barco is adapting well to a new central midfield role after previously operating primarily as a left-back / wing-back. The speed of this transition highlights strong football intelligence and technical comfort.

He projects as a box-to-box central midfielder, best suited to a support 8 role alongside a holding midfielder. This setup allows him to maximise his strengths in build-up, progression, and chance creation while continuing to develop central defensive responsibilities. He is currently well suited to operating as a lone pivot when in possession but out of possession is somewhat lacking.

Barco appears technically and mentally ready to compete at a high level, including against elite opposition. Defensive consistency and game management remain the key development areas, but given his age and positional transition, these are developmental rather than limiting factors.

Recommendation

Displays strong long-term potential and merits continued observation to assess consistency as he settles further into his role.